At Multan, Virender Sehwag played a blinder. We won the toss and from the word go he was in control. He played some outstanding shots and his innings had the effect of demoralizing the opposition on the very first day of the series. He flayed the Pakistani bowlers to all parts of the ground and by the time I joined him in the middle he was already well past his century.

I remember that just after tea Sehwag seemed to lose concentration. He began trying to hit every ball and looked a bit agitated. I walked up to him to calm him down and told him that he just needed to hang in there and let this spell pass. I also said to him that he should check himself a bit, as something big was about to happen. It was important to grab this opportunity and not let it slip away. I was glad to see him grind it out on his way to a double hundred. As soon as he reached the milestone, he was back in his groove and the shots started to flow again. I was even more delighted when he managed to get to a triple hundred on the second morning. It was an incredible effort and coming against Pakistan made it all the more special.

By the time Sehwag reached that landmark, I had made a century. I had paced my innings nicely and we were now firmly in the driver's seat. At teatime I asked stand-in skipper Rahul Dravid, who was in charge because Sourav was out with a back injury, and coach John Wright what the plan was. I was informed that we were looking to give Pakistan an hour to bat and so would put them in with fifteen overs left on the second day.

It was perfectly sensible and I went about my business after tea with this plan in mind. In fact, I was pacing my innings so that I could reach my double hundred and we could still give Pakistan fifteen overs to bat, as was the plan. But then, a little more than half an hour into the post-tea session, Ramesh Powar, who was substituting in the game, came onto the field and asked me to accelerate. I even joked with him, saying I was aware that we needed quick runs but with the field totally spread out, there was only so much we could do.

A little later, when I was on 194, he came out again and said that I should try and get to my double hundred in that over itself because Rahul had decided to declare. I was startled, to say the least, because in my mind I still had twelve balls in which to score the remaining six runs before fifteen overs were left for the day. However, as it happened, I did not get to play a single ball in that over, with Yuvraj on strike against